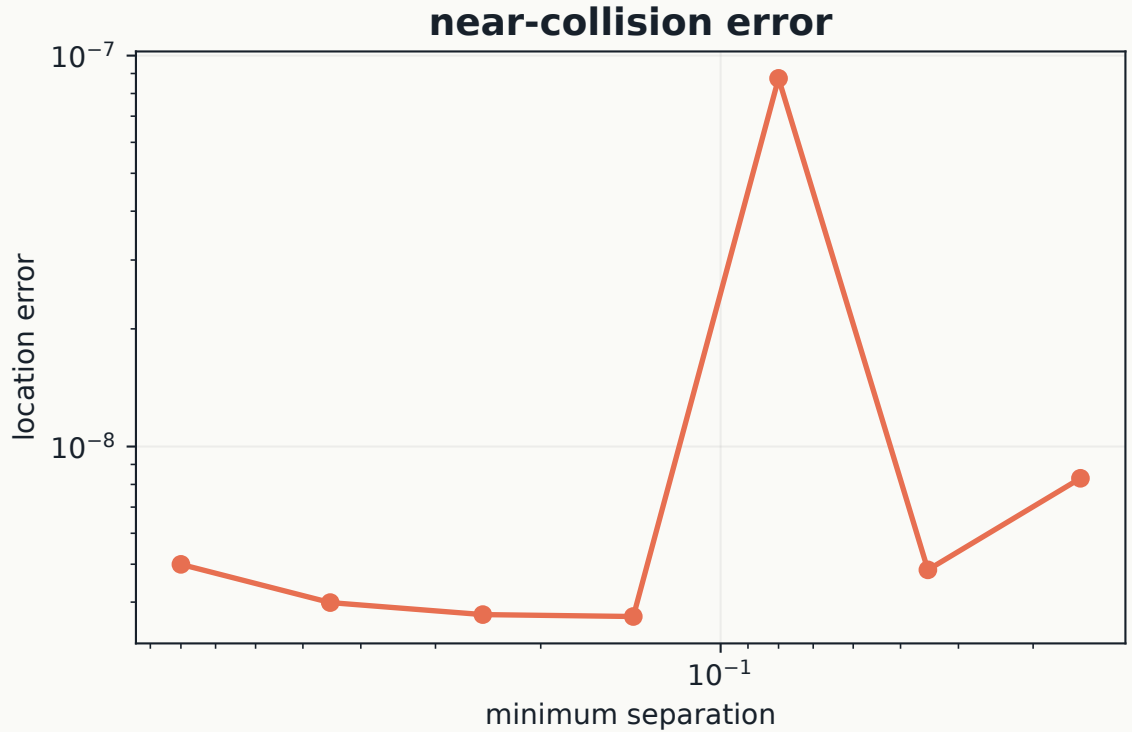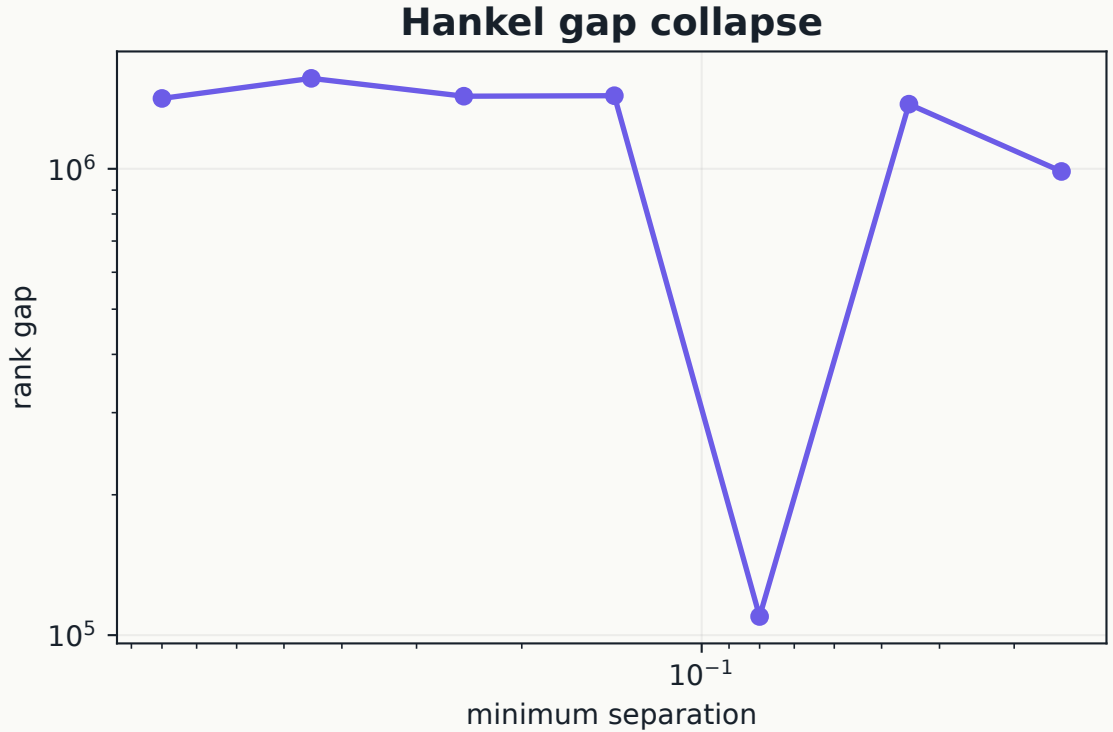The method exposes rather than hides the separation barrier